THE MASTERMIND COACHING CLASSES

CBSE / RBSE • NURSERY – CLASS XII • JAIPUR

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CLASS 8 — SOCIAL SCIENCE · HARD LEVEL CHAPTER TEST SET 3

Chapter 3: **The Rise of the Marathas** | RBSE Pattern | Session 2026–27

Time: 1 Hour 30 Minutes Name: _____ Roll No.: _____ **Maximum Marks: 40**

General Instructions:

1. All questions are compulsory.
2. Q. 1–10 are Objective Type (1 mark each).
3. Q. 11–14 are Very Short Answer Type (2 marks each).
4. Q. 15–18 are Short Answer Type (3 marks each).
5. Q. 19–20 are Long Answer Type (5 marks each).
6. Internal choice is given in Q. 17 to 20.
7. Write the question number before each answer.
8. Hard level: application and higher-order questions.

SECTION — A (Objective Type Questions) 10 × 1 = 10

Choose the correct option and write it in your answer book.

1. Which of these best expresses the legacy of Shivaji for India? 1

(a) Idea of self-rule and efficient governance
(b) Isolation
(c) End of trade
(d) Large debts

2. Panipat 1761 shows that a large army can be defeated by 1

(a) monsoons only **(b)** forts
(c) no army **(d)** a better organised and led force

3. The Maratha Empire is called a confederacy because 1

(a) one ruler governed all
(b) Mughals ruled
(c) no leaders
(d) regional chiefs ruled under the Peshwa's leadership

4. A teacher says, 'The Marathas ended the Mughals.' Choose the best reply 1

(a) They weakened the Mughals but the Empire fell due to many causes
(b) Mughals won all wars
(c) Fully correct
(d) Marathas never fought the Mughals

5. A historian reading Modi script documents can learn about 1

(a) Chinese trade **(b)** Persian poetry
(c) Roman law **(d)** Maratha administration

6. Which factor was NOT a reason for the decline of the Marathas? 1

(a) Disunity **(b)** Succession disputes
(c) British technology **(d)** Strong unity among chiefs

7. Which describes Ahilyabai as a source of inspiration? 1

(a) A queen of the Mughals
(b) A ruler who governed with justice and service
(c) A trader
(d) A general who ignored people

8. When Shivaji ordered that mango trees must not be cut, he was showing 1

(a) tax **(b)** war plans
(c) greed **(d)** care for farmers' resources

9. **Assertion (A):** The Marathas continued to resist the Mughals after Shivaji's death. 1
Reason (R): Rajaram took shelter in Gingee fort and later Tarabai led the resistance.
Choose the correct option:
(a) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A.
(b) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A.
(c) A is true but R is false.
(d) A is false but R is true.

10. **Assertion (A):** Ahilyabai Holkar is remembered for rebuilding the temple at Kashi. 1
Reason (R): Mahadji Shinde recovered Delhi for the Marathas in 1771.
Choose the correct option:
(a) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A.
(b) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A.
(c) A is true but R is false.
(d) A is false but R is true.

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer Type) — 4 × 2 = 8

Answer in about 20–30 words each.

11. Why did Peshwas become powerful? 2

12. Why do historians value Modi records? 2

13. Why was the sack of Surat strategically smart? 2

14. What did Shivaji's coronation signify for his subjects? 2

SECTION — C (Short Answer Type) — 4 × 3 = 12

Answer in about 40–60 words each.

15. Case: A Maratha chief and the Peshwa disagree. Explain how a confederacy could suffer. 3

16. Evaluate the role of Jijabai in shaping Shivaji. 3

17. Examine the importance of Thanjavur Marathas to culture. 3

OR

Evaluate Shivaji's use of both force and diplomacy. 3

18. Assess the claim that Shivaji was a nation-builder. 3

OR

Assess whether the Peshwas strengthened or weakened the Maratha state. 3

SECTION — D (Long Answer Type) — 2 × 5 = 10

Answer in about 100–150 words each.

19. **Case study.** Shivaji ran his kingdom with a council of eight ministers called the Ashta Pradhana Mandala. To raise money, the Marathas collected chauth, one-fourth of the revenue of neighbouring areas, and an extra levy called sardeshmukhi. 5
(i) What share of revenue was chauth?
(ii) What share was sardeshmukhi?
(iii) What was the council of eight ministers called?
(iv) Why was such revenue important to the Marathas?

20. Case study: A woman ruler governs for thirty years, builds ghats and temples and delivers justice. Identify her and evaluate her rule. 5

OR

Explain how the Marathas contributed to creating a pan-Indian political presence in the 18th century. 5

END OF QUESTION PAPER — Total: 40 Marks